

experienced, and it protects you if you ever get divorced. A divorce is so much easier if you have your own advisor and your own funds; you'll be able to split your assets without missing a beat.

This isn't just a safeguard in case of divorce. Financial independence is the bedrock of a healthy partnership. Think about it: your partner is your equal, and a good relationship is built on a healthy system of checks and balances. We've already said that money is the number one reason couples break up. Why on earth would you want to create an imbalance in such an important area? Being financially dependent on your partner is like playing with matches: you're both going to get burned. Instead, you should have your own accounts, your own relationships with financial institutions and your own stocks and bonds—even if it's just a small amount. You are essentially creating your own financial infrastructure as a kind of safety net.



My mother, Georgette, was an astute investor. She believed in keeping a close watch on her money. She would meet with her financial advisor often and would invest only in stocks that paid dividends and bonds with cash interest. She drilled into my head the mantra “Never spend the principal, only the interest.” Today O’Leary Funds is built on this simple but effective principle.